

PennLINC Assistant · Tester Guide

A troubleshooting assistant for the lab's BIDS Apps — and you're helping us test it.

It answers questions and diagnoses errors for **qsiprep**, **qsirecon**, **aslprep**, **xcp_d**, **cubids**, and **ModelArray** — the way a maintainer would, with a link back to the source behind every answer. Poke at it and tell us where it falls short.

1 Getting in

- Open the link and enter the shared password we sent you.
- Pick a tool on the home page. Switch tools anytime from the sidebar, or click ← **All tools** to go back.

2 How to test well

- **Ask questions you already know the answer to.** That's what lets you judge whether the response is actually right.
- **Try the hard stuff.** Paste a real traceback, ask a version-specific question (“on **qsiprep** 26.0.0...”), or a cross-tool question.

One question per chat → use + New chat

Start a fresh chat for each new, unrelated question (the + **New chat** button in the sidebar). The feedback panel always rates the **most recent answer** in a thread, so a chat with several unrelated questions makes your ratings ambiguous. Follow-ups on the *same* topic are fine — keep those together.

3 What to try

Aim to hit a few different kinds of question — the mix is what stress-tests it. Ideas to get you started:

Try this	For example
A quick how-to	“How do I set --output-resolution in qsiprep ?”
Paste a real error	Drop in the full traceback you actually hit — see if it finds the raising line and links it.
Pin a version	“On qsiprep 1.1.1 , where is the eddy cnr_maps check?”
A ‘used to work’ change	“My xcp_d output changed between versions — what changed and when?”
A cross-tool question	“Which qsiprep outputs does qsirecon need as input?”
Something obscure	Ask a genuinely niche question — does it admit it doesn't know, or invent an answer?
A follow-up	Ask a clarifying follow-up on the same answer — keep it in the same chat.

Not a power user? Test the parts you use.

Plenty of us just consume these outputs in our analyses without ever running the pipelines — and those questions are just as useful to test. Ask about a flag, an output file, or which derivative to use:

- “What does the **--output-resolution** flag do?”
- “What is the `*_desc-preproc_dwi.nii.gz` file, and how is it different from the raw data?”
- “Which `qsiprep` output should I feed into tractography?”
- “What space are the outputs in, and how do I get them into MNI?”
- “What do the columns in the `confounds / QC` file mean?”

4 How to give feedback

Under each answer, open **“Rate this answer / report a problem.”** Rate the answer in front of you *before* moving on to a new question.

- **Thumbs up or down** — was it useful?
- **If it wasn't good, pick a category** — wrong fix, bad or broken sources, made-up detail, wrong version, or didn't ask for enough info.
- **Paste the correct source URL when you know it.** This is the single most valuable thing you can give us (see below).

Why the correct URL matters most

When you point us at the right issue, thread, or doc, your correction becomes a permanent test we re-run after every change — so the same mistake can't come back. A thumbs-down with the right link is worth far more than a thumbs-down alone.

5 Please keep in mind

- **Testing preview:** your chat history is saved for evaluation. **Please don't enter personal or sensitive information.**
- **It can be wrong** — that's what we're testing. Don't act on an answer without checking the source it links to.
- **Hard questions take a bit.** For a pasted traceback it may work for ~a minute while it reads the code; that's normal.

Thanks for testing — every rating you log makes it better. Questions or problems? Contact the maintainers.